The 6:15

TUESDAY · OCTOBER 6, 2026 NO. 23

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Wed 10/7, 8:00p ET	Yankees host Rays, ALDS Gm 3 — Yankees face elimination, down 0-2 (truTV, Yankee Stadium)
Wed 10/8	Knicks preseason home opener vs. Washington, Madison Square Garden
Sat 10/10	Northwestern hosts Ball State, Homecoming, Ryan Field
Tue 10/14, 8:30a ET	September CPI (BLS) **(no consensus located this run)**
Wed 10/15, 8:30a ET	September PPI; advance retail sales
Oct 12-16	~48 companies report earnings (Nasdaq calendar); none individually verified this run **(flag)**

Standing: FOMC meets Oct. 27-28 — hike odds now a cycle-low ~17% after Friday's payrolls miss (see Lead). Funding runs on the Dec. 11 CR, no shutdown risk [continuity]. US-China truce to Jan. 10 unchanged [continuity]. No new frontier-AI release, rocket launch, or VC mega-round verified this run — skipped rather than padded.

METRICS · ET UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI / spread	$98.56-99.45 (feeds diverge) / $87.78, intraday ~6:10-6:25a **(no settle yet)**; Mon. settle Brent $100.32 (-1.9%), WTI $89.43 (-1.8%); spread ~$10.8
2y / 10y / 30y	4.812% (-0.43%) / 5.276% (-0.70%) / 5.637% (-0.48%), ~6:20a
DXY	101.77 (-0.16%), ~6:24a **(Dec. futures contract, not spot index)**
S&P / Nasdaq futures / VIX	ESZ26 7,843.25 (+0.22%) / NQ 31,424.00 (+0.34%), delayed ~6:14a; VIX 15.43 (-0.58%), ~6:01a
Gold	$4,180.65 (+0.57%), ~6:24a **(Dec. futures contract)**

Asia / Europe	Nikkei closed +1.26% (70,826.00); Hang Seng closed +1.00% (24,280.56). FTSE 10,552.50 (+0.52%), DAX 25,420.96 (+0.66%) — both intraday, not closes
Retail gas (AAA)	$4.3685/gal today **(same AAA report cites $4.41 elsewhere — internal inconsistency flagged, not resolved)**

All equity/FX/rates levels above are real-time or delayed intraday reads as of ~6-6:25a ET; no US settle or close has occurred yet this morning.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Transits	1 on Sept. 27 vs. 85/day pre-crisis baseline (IMF PortWatch) **(feed unchanged in 10 days)**
Vessels holding	191 AIS-visible, 10:21 UTC today (straits.live) — 8-day range 89-285, treated as noise
Dark tankers (24h)	148 of 291 screened (baseline avg 84.2) (straits.live)
Strikes, 24h / running	UKMTO: 4 tankers struck + 1 threatened since Sunday, most intense spell since Feb. 28 war start; latest 16:37 UTC Mon., engine-room fire, no casualties. Weekly total (11 ships, straits.live) **(single-sourced)**
War-risk premia	~$10.0M per VLCC transit, ~30x pre-crisis (straits.live/insurance estimates) — consistent with issue No. 22
Crisis Pressure	88/100 "extreme," flat 24h; Escalation Forecast 58/100 "elevated," flat 24h **(straits.live switched from qualitative bands to numeric scores since issue No. 22 — not strictly comparable)**

Transit counts (PortWatch, lagged), AIS holding counts (same-day, volatile) and war-risk premia (periodic insurance-market reporting) measure different things over different windows and vendors; never averaged or differenced here. A Hormuz-reopening-by-Oct.-31 prediction-market contract prices 2% — sentiment, not a primary source.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Lost Gm 2, 5-2, at Tampa Bay; ALDS 0-2, face elimination Wed.
Knicks	Lost preseason opener, 97-120, at Philadelphia
Northwestern	Beat Penn State, 34-13; 3-1 overall, 1-1 Big Ten

LEAD

RATES — PAYROLLS MISS, OIL DECOUPLES FROM THE WAR

Fed hike odds for Oct. 28 collapse to a cycle-low ~17% after September payrolls badly miss — but oil is falling for reasons that have nothing to do with the Fed, even as Hormuz tanker strikes hit a wartime high

September nonfarm payrolls, released Friday 8:30a ET, printed +29,000 against a consensus near 84,000-90,000 — one of the widest misses of the cycle. [fact] The unemployment rate rose to 4.2% from 4.1% (consensus had looked for 4.1% unchanged); July and August payrolls were revised down a combined 60,000, leaving a net loss of 31,000 jobs once revisions are included; average hourly earnings rose just 0.1% m/m to $37.81, the softest wage print in months. [fact] Health care led the sparse job gains, adding 17,000 — itself below its own 12-month average of 33,000. [fact]

The repricing was immediate and large. Odds of a quarter-point hike at the Oct. 27-28 FOMC meeting collapsed to roughly 17% — a cycle low — from the high-70s just before the report, with "no change" probability surging to about 83%. [fact] That continues, and resolves, the thread this brief flagged Thursday: issue No. 22 reported hike odds already cratering to ~35% on a cooler-than-expected August PCE print; Friday's payrolls miss took the legs out from under the remainder of the hike case entirely. [DEVELOPING] December hike odds are holding up better, near 65% for the Dec. 9 meeting — the market's read is a hold in October with the tightening debate deferred, not abandoned. [fact/read] Equities celebrated: the Nasdaq Composite crossed 31,000 intraday for the first time ever Friday, the Dow added roughly 340 points, and chipmakers led, with

Intel and AMD each up more than 3% as the 10-year fell more than 5bp to 5.176%. [fact] This morning's futures (S&P +0.22%, Nasdaq 100 +0.34%) extend that into the new week, and the 10-year's current 5.276% is still below its level before Friday's report. [fact]

Oil did not follow the dovish-data playbook — and in fact moved the opposite way from Thursday's pattern, when this brief noted crude pricing off the Hormuz risk premium rather than Fed data. Brent settled Monday at $100.32 (-1.9%), WTI at $89.43 (-1.8%); both are down again intraday Tuesday — Brent in a $98.56-99.45 range depending on feed, WTI at $87.78, no settle yet. [fact/flag] That's happening even as UKMTO disclosed Monday that four tankers were struck and a fifth directly threatened since Sunday — the most intense stretch of attacks since the US-Iran war began Feb. 28. [NEW, fact] Mechanism: Middle East crude exports topped pre-war levels on four of the last seven days despite the attacks, meaning physical flow through and around the strait is proving more resilient than the strike headlines imply; G7 nations agreed over the weekend, under pressure from Trump, to release 100 million barrels of crude and diesel from emergency reserves and pledged to avoid export restrictions; and Saudi Aramco just cut its November Arab Light price to Asia by $5/barrel below the regional benchmark — a materially deeper discount than October's $2 cut, reading as Riyadh positioning for soft demand rather than tight supply. [read]

Stakes: rates and equities are now trading off a softening labor market; oil is trading off exports-and-reserve-release logistics that have, for the moment, decoupled from the war headlines entirely — a genuine divergence, not noise. Oct. 14 CPI is now the swing print for whether the Fed's October hold becomes consensus or the December hike case reasserts on firmer inflation; watch whether

IMF PortWatch's transit count — still frozen at a single vessel on Sept. 27 — ever catches up to the exports data, and whether Wednesday's elimination-game Yankees-Rays or the stalled Qatar-mediated Iran talks (below) produce anything concrete before the weekend.

POLITICS

An NBC News poll released Sunday put Democrats ahead by eight points on the generic congressional ballot heading into next month's midterms, with 66% of voters describing themselves as highly interested in the race. [NEW, fact] That eight-point margin matches where Democrats stood ahead of 2018, when they flipped 40 House seats; outlets summarizing the same poll read it as a meaningful tailwind for Democratic House prospects, though a single poll weeks out is a read, not a result. [read] The September CR that funds the government through Dec. 11 remains the operative fact keeping a shutdown off the table through Election Day [continuity] — unchanged since issue No. 22, not re-adjectived further here.

ECONOMICS

September's ISM Manufacturing PMI, released Thursday, printed 54.6 against a 55.2 consensus — a miss, though still comfortably in expansion territory. [fact, single-sourced via secondary coverage, not confirmed directly against ism.org this run — flag] That release is now secondary to Friday's payrolls miss (Lead) as the data point setting the Fed's near-term path. Oct. 14 CPI and Oct. 15 PPI are the next load-bearing prints; no consensus for either located as of writing. [flag] The question markets are now asking is whether a softening labor market and an already-cooling PCE combine to pull

core inflation down fast enough to make the Fed's December tightening odds (~65%) fade the way October's just did.

BUSINESS

Nike's actual FQ1 2027 results, reported Thursday after close, beat on EPS and missed narrowly on revenue against the consensus this brief cross-verified Tuesday: $0.48 diluted EPS (vs. $0.44 consensus) on $11.2B revenue (vs. $11.33B consensus), down 4% reported / 5% currency-neutral y/y. [NEW, fact] Gross margin rose 60bp to 42.8% on supply-chain cost management and FX tailwinds; Greater China revenue fell 26% as the company's marketplace reset continues to pressure that region. [fact] Guidance: FY27 revenue to decline at a high-single-digit rate, adjusted EPS $1.15-$1.35 excluding roughly $0.15/share tied to the Pace restructuring program. [fact] The next earnings cluster is Oct. 12-16 (~48 companies per Nasdaq's calendar); none individually verified this run. [flag]

GEOPOLITICS

Russia launched roughly 87 drones and four missiles at Ukraine overnight, targeting Kyiv and the Black Sea port of Odesa; Ukrainian air defense intercepted 56 drones and two missiles, and Kherson's governor reported one civilian dead and 15 injured in the region over the past 24 hours. [NEW, fact] No other casualty figures confirmed as of writing. [flag] OPEC+'s Joint Ministerial Monitoring Committee met over the weekend (resolving Sunday's calendar item) and reiterated it is "committed to current output policy," giving no fresh guidance on the pace of unwinding the group's voluntary 2.2mn b/d cuts — the panel repeated that the phase-out "could be paused or reversed" depending on market conditions. [DEVELOPING, fact] US-China truce to Jan. 10 stands unchanged. [continuity]

IRAN & HORMUZ

UKMTO disclosed Monday that four tankers were struck by unidentified projectiles and a fifth directly threatened since Sunday — the most intense attack spell since the US-Iran war began Feb. 28. [NEW, fact] The latest hit a transiting tanker at 16:37 UTC Monday, starting an engine-room fire the crew fought without reported casualties or pollution. [fact] UKMTO and the Joint Maritime Information Center describe the pattern as concentrated on the Omani side of the strait, including one incident where a drone entered a tanker's funnel and ignited in the engine room; several struck vessels have temporarily lost propulsion before continuing independently or under tow. [fact] No attribution has been made. [flag]

Diplomatically, Qatari mediators were set to hold separate talks with FM Araghchi and with the US side in New York Monday or Tuesday on an amended version of Iran's seven-day Hormuz-reopening proposal — an end to hostilities, unfreezing Iranian assets, lifting sanctions on Iranian oil exports and the port blockade, in exchange for reopening the strait and resuming nuclear talks. [continuity/NEW] Trump has called the proposal "unacceptable" in public remarks; Araghchi says Tehran is awaiting a "definitive" formal response through mediators rather than treating Trump's statements as official. No outcome from the New York round is confirmed as of writing. [flag]

Despite the strike escalation, the physical and flow picture is mixed rather than uniformly worse: straits.live's board (10:21 UTC today) shows transits still frozen at 1 vessel on Sept. 27 against an 85/day baseline — IMF PortWatch's feed hasn't posted a newer day in ten days [flag, lagged] — while 191 vessels sit AIS-visible and holding (8-day range 89-285, noisy) and 148 of 291 screened tankers are running dark versus an 84.2 baseline. [straits.live, single-sourced] War-risk premia hold near $10.0M per VLCC transit, roughly 30x pre-crisis. Crisis Pressure reads 88/100 ("extreme"), Escalation Forecast 58/100 ("elevated"), both flat over 24 hours — note the site has shifted from the qualitative bands used in issue No. 22 to numeric scores, which may not be a like-for-like comparison. [flag] A prediction-market contract on Hormuz reopening by Oct. 31 prices just 2% — a sentiment read, not a primary source. [flag] Yet Mideast crude exports topped pre-war levels on four of the last seven days, and Saudi Aramco just deepened its November Asian discount (see Lead) — the oil market is, for now, trading the export data over the strike count.

SPORTS

Yankees	Lost Gm 2, 5-2, at Tampa Bay; ALDS 0-2, face elimination Wed., Gm 3, 8:00p ET, Yankee Stadium (truTV).
Knicks	Lost preseason opener, 97-120, at Philadelphia; next Wed. 10/8 vs. Washington, MSG (home opener).
Northwestern	Beat Penn State, 34-13; 3-1 overall, 1-1 Big Ten; hosts Ball State Sat. 10/10 (Homecoming).

Continuity. Cut from issue No. 22 as unmoved: Technology (no new frontier-AI release, rocket launch, or VC mega-round verified this run, second issue running) and the US-China truce detail beyond a one-line standing note. Not refreshed this run: Asia/Europe cash closes beyond what's listed (European reads are intraday, not closes, as of writing); CPI/PPI consensus for Oct. 14/15; individual names in the Oct. 12-16 earnings cluster. Watch for next issue: the New York Qatar-mediated talks outcome; Wednesday's Yankees elimination game; whether PortWatch's transit count ever updates past Sept. 27; Oct. 14 CPI as the next Fed-path data point.

Unverified figures are marked in red above. ISM 54.6 single-sourced via secondary coverage, not confirmed against ism.org; all straits.live Hormuz figures (vessel counts, dark-tanker count, Crisis Pressure/Escalation Forecast scores, weekly strike total) single-sourced; AAA gas figure internally inconsistent on its own source page ($4.3685 vs. $4.41 cited elsewhere on the same report); no Brent/WTI settle this morning; DXY and gold quotes are December futures contracts, not spot index levels; Hormuz-reopening prediction-market odds are sentiment, not a primary source; no outcome confirmed for Monday/Tuesday's New York talks. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.